COVE DIGITAL

PROJECT PROPOSAL

Calder Wheels Commerce & Operations Platform

A custom store, configurator, and build-to-order system for the new wheel company

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What this proposal covers

A clear picture of what I'll build, what it costs, and how long it takes.

This proposal is for the **Calder Wheels** platform — the new store, the wheel configurator, the wholesale ordering, and the systems that keep inventory and accounting correct behind the scenes.

> A custom online store where a customer can pick a wheel, change its finishes, see it update in real time, get an accurate price, and order it — backed by a system that knows exactly what parts you have, what can be built, and what each order did to your inventory and your books.

That's a lot more than a website. That's why it's priced and scoped the way it is.

The two pieces of this project

PIECE 1

Calder Wheels commerce platform

The customer-facing build: storefront, wheel configurator, retail and wholesale ordering, fitment, galleries, and the inventory logic that makes “build to order” actually work online.

PIECE 2

Operations architecture

The behind-the-scenes system: deciding what Shopify, QuickBooks, ShipStation, and the automation layer each own — so every system agrees on inventory, accounting, and fulfillment without manual double-entry.

In other words: **the store your customers see, and the engine that runs the business behind it.** Both are included in this proposal.

What you're actually buying

Each component of the platform, in plain English.

1 The Shopify storefront

A premium, photography-led store that looks and feels like a high-end wheel brand. Not a template with your logo slapped on — a custom design built around your product photography.

- Overall look and navigation
- Homepage, wheel catalog, and product pages
- Customer accounts and retail checkout
- Mobile-friendly layout throughout

2 The wheel configurator Priority

The centerpiece. A customer picks a wheel, then changes its **center**, its **barrel/lip**, and its **hardware/finish** — and sees the wheel update on screen in real time, with the price updating as they go.

- **Version one uses layered 2D images.** I take the renderings you already have and build a configurator that swaps layers for each finish — more practical and reliable than a full 3D engine, as long as the renderings are consistent in angle, lighting, and transparency.
- **The vehicle visualizer is intentionally deferred.** It's a strong Phase 2 opportunity, but I'm not burying an expensive experimental feature in the initial price.

3 Retail + wholesale ordering

Two ways to buy, in one system.

- **Retail** — a normal customer configures and checks out with a card.
- **Wholesale / dealer** — approved dealer accounts, tiered pricing, dealer-only products, payment terms, and minimum order quantities.

The dealer side is a first-class part of the build, not an afterthought bolted onto a customer login.

4 Component / BOM inventory logic The important part

This is the part most people don't see, and the reason the whole thing works. You don't stock finished wheels — you stock **parts** and assemble to order. So the store shouldn't ask “how many wheels are on the shelf?” It should ask “**how many wheels can we build right now?**”

Every finished wheel breaks down into a recipe: **Center × 1 + Barrel/Lip × 1 + Hardware × N.** The system tracks the parts, and “available” means “we have enough parts to build it.” If one part runs out, the wheel shows out of stock — even if the other parts are piled high.

This same structure leaves room for the real-world situations you've described — scratched or blemished parts, rework, replacement builds, B-stock. I won't build all of that in version one, but I'll design the inventory so it's not impossible later.

What you're actually buying (continued)

5 QuickBooks integration

When an order is placed, the accounting gets it right, automatically. Sales, cost of goods, and inventory values flow into QuickBooks without someone hand-entering them.

6 Galleries + interconnected product discovery

Two ways to browse: **vehicle-first** (see a wheel on a car) and **wheel-first** (see the wheel itself). Plus fitment that connects vehicles to the wheels that actually fit them, so a customer never sees a product that doesn't fit their car.

7 SEO / AEO

The store is built so search engines — and AI assistants — can actually find and understand your products. This matters more every year.

8 Ongoing content & product maintenance

After launch, someone has to keep adding wheels, finishes, renderings, fitment data, and pricing changes. That's covered in the maintenance section at the end.

9 Vehicle-on-car visualizer — not in this phase

As agreed, deferred. It'll be its own project later.

What the launch catalog assumes

To be upfront about scope, this price assumes:

- A **small initial catalog** — roughly one wheel to start, with the architecture built to absorb more wheels later.
- A **2D configurator**, not a photorealistic 3D engine.
- The **vehicle visualizer is excluded** from Phase 1.

A true interactive vehicle visualizer could run $5,000–$15,000+ on its own depending on the rendering tech and vehicle database, so leaving it out of the initial build keeps the first version focused and affordable.

The operations architecture

This answers one question that, if ignored, turns into a mess later:

> Which system owns what?

When Shopify, QuickBooks, and ShipStation all talk to each other, the danger is ending up with three places showing three different inventory numbers. This work prevents that by establishing:

- What Shopify owns
- What QuickBooks owns
- What ShipStation owns
- What the automation layer owns
- **Which system is the single source of truth for inventory**

The deliverable is a clear system where everyone — you, your team, and the software — agrees on who's in charge of what.

Investment

Here are the numbers, straight.

Workstream	Price
Calder Wheels commerce platform	**$11,750**
Operations architecture	**$3,500**
Combined — bundled	**$14,500**

The two pieces separately total $15,250. Authorizing both together saves **$750**.

> I recommend the bundled option — it's the complete system, and the better value.

What's not included (paid directly by you)

Third-party software and subscriptions are separate from my implementation fee:

- Shopify subscription
- Any premium theme or B2B/configurator apps I end up using
- QuickBooks and ShipStation
- Email/SMS and search/filter apps
- Any premium fitment data source

My fee is for building and implementing. Ongoing software licenses are your direct costs.

Timeline

Estimated implementation: 6–8 weeks from kickoff, assuming product data, renderings, pricing, finishes, dealer terms, and fitment info arrive on schedule. That last part matters — a big chunk depends on you defining which part numbers make up each wheel, and I won't absorb delays from missing data into my timeline.

Weeks	Focus
1–2	Architecture, design mockups, configurator UX — you approve before I code
3–4	Core store: design, catalog, product pages, accounts, checkout, wholesale structure
5–6	Configurator, fitment, galleries, dealer pricing, inventory sync, QuickBooks + ShipStation
7	Full workflow testing — retail and wholesale, edge cases, mobile
8	Final revisions, launch prep, training, documentation

Target launch: late September to early October 2026 (October 10 as the safe completion point).

How payment works

I don't ask for everything up front, and I don't do a bare-bones deposit. Payment tracks the milestones where real value is delivered.

Milestone	Amount
Kickoff — discovery, architecture, mockups	**$4,350 · 30%**
Design & system approval	**$4,350 · 30%**
Functional beta — site, configurator, integrations live in staging	**$3,625 · 25%**
Before production launch	**$2,175 · 15%**

The kickoff payment is non-refundable once discovery and design work begins.

If a lighter cash-flow schedule is easier, I can also do a 25% deposit followed by $2,175 every two weeks (five payments), for the same $14,500 total.

After launch

A wheel store like this is a living thing — new wheels, new finishes, new renders, fitment changes, price updates, dealer changes. I recommend a monthly plan to keep it moving without negotiating every change.

Plan	Monthly	Includes
Care	**$350**	Up to 3 hrs/mo
Commerce Recommended	**$650**	**Up to 7 hrs/mo**
Growth	**$950**	Up to 11 hrs/mo

I recommend starting on the **Commerce plan at $650/month** — Shopify maintenance, product updates, new wheel setup, finish changes, dealer changes, gallery additions, fitment updates, integration monitoring, sync troubleshooting, minor design changes, SEO monitoring, and a monthly backup, up to 7 hours a month. Additional time is **$85/hour**.

New wheel models

A new wheel is more than typing in a name — it needs component mapping, SKU, BOM, pricing, finishes, images, config layers, fitment, copy, SEO, and gallery relationships. Depending on the wheel and rendering work, I'd scope those at roughly:

- **$250–$400** — a standard wheel
- **$400–$650** — a highly configurable wheel
- Or deducted from maintenance hours

That way catalog growth doesn't quietly eat unlimited maintenance time.

> **30 days of post-launch stabilization is included at no charge** — I fix anything in the approved scope that isn't working right. It's not 30 days of free new features. After that, the monthly plan begins.

Two options, for simplicity

OPTION A

Calder Commerce Platform

$11,750

Everything customer-facing: the store, the configurator, and the wholesale system. Operations architecture can be added later for $3,500.

OPTION B · BUNDLED

Complete Commerce & Operations System

$14,500

The full system — $750 less than buying the pieces separately.

I recommend Option B.

The short version

What	Details
Deliverable	A custom wheel e-commerce platform: storefront, configurator, retail + wholesale, build-to-order inventory, QuickBooks + ShipStation integration, galleries, SEO
Not included	Vehicle visualizer (Phase 2), third-party software subscriptions
Price	$14,500 bundled
Timeline	6–8 weeks
Payment	30% / 30% / 25% / 15%
After launch	30-day stabilization, then $650/mo recommended

Thank you for the opportunity. I'm ready to start when you are.